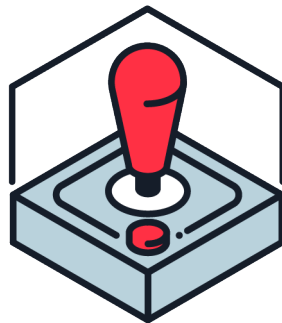




Video Game Metadata Schema: Controlled Vocabulary for **VISUAL STYLE**

University of Washington Information School
Game Research (GAMER) Group and
Seattle Interactive Media Museum



GAMER
GAME RESEARCH GROUP

Release 1.6
2024-12-12

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Suggested Citation

Please cite this document as follows:

Lee, J. H., Perti, A., Cho, H., et al. (2024). *UW/SIMM Video Game Metadata Schema: Controlled Vocabulary for Visual Style*. Version 1.6. Retrieved from:
<https://github.com/uwgamergroup/vocabulary-visual-style>

Version History

1.6: June 2015
1.6: September 2024
1.6: December 2024 - Updated reference structure for improved visual clarity and usability. Adjusted layout from landscape to portrait, updated images for certain games, and removed numbers from CV terms for clarity. No changes to core content.

Abbreviation Key

The following abbreviations are used throughout:

SN: Scope note

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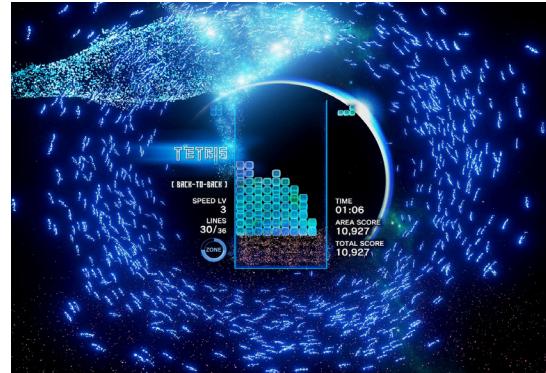
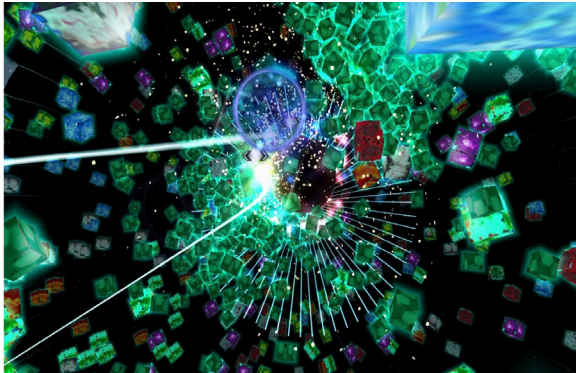
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Controlled Vocabulary for Visual Style

1. Style

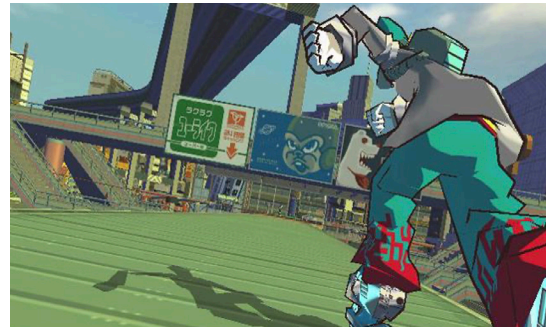
Abstract

SN: Abstract is a visual style describing distinct, non-character based forms. Fractal imagery using a palette with strong colors is a good example. These styles can be symmetrical, geometric, or feature kaleidoscopically swirling patterns.



Cel-shaded

SN: A technique of rendering light and shadow to enhance the illusion of a 3D surface, giving the modeled entity a cartoon-like appearance due to the effect of rounding the edges and eliminating gradations of color. It also gives a feel of hand-drawn animation.



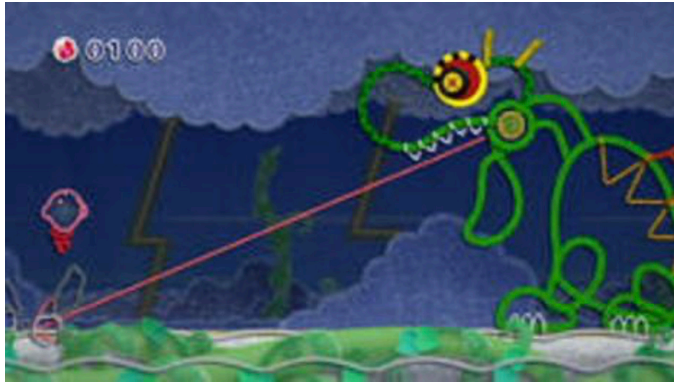
Comic book (Anime/Manga)

SN: A visual style replicating common artistic elements found in mass-market comic books, such as accentuated character features and broad line strokes.



Handicraft

SN: A visual style replicating aspects of hand-made and hand-crafted objects. It includes a strong emphasis on specific textures and surfaces. Examples include paper, yarn, and clay.



Lego

SN: The distinctive look of LEGO™ figures and sets.



Map-based

SN: A visual style emphasizing maps and map-based gameplay. Game spaces usually consist of small rectangular or hexagonal graphic images like tiles, and players typically have a top-down or isometric view throughout gameplay.



Pixel art

SN: The use of pixelated, typically sprite-based visuals found in early 8 and 16-bit games, and in modern games intending to replicate it.



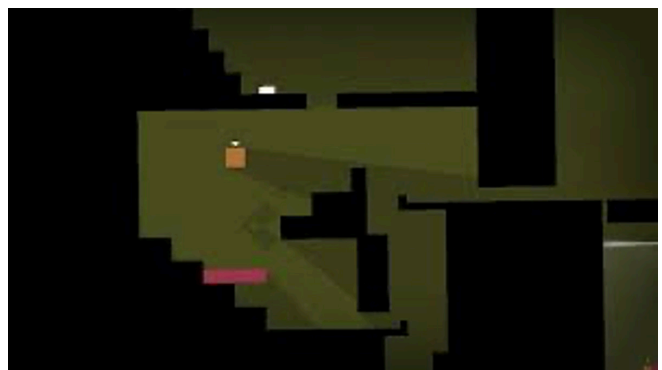
Realistic

SN: A style portraying characters and environments by attempting to achieve visual parity with real-world references.



Silhouette

SN: A style in which characters or environments are represented as a solid shape of a single color, or only a couple of colors, usually black. The interior of a silhouette is often featureless, and the whole is typically presented with a sparse background.



Stylized

SN: An illustrative style capturing or distorting distinctive features of a character or object in order to capture a visual likeness. Simplified characters or objects can be considered stylized.



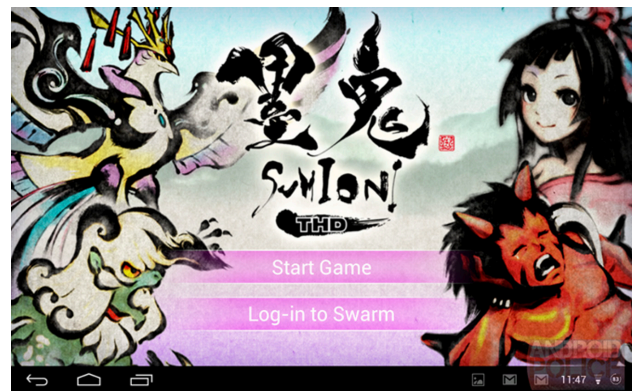
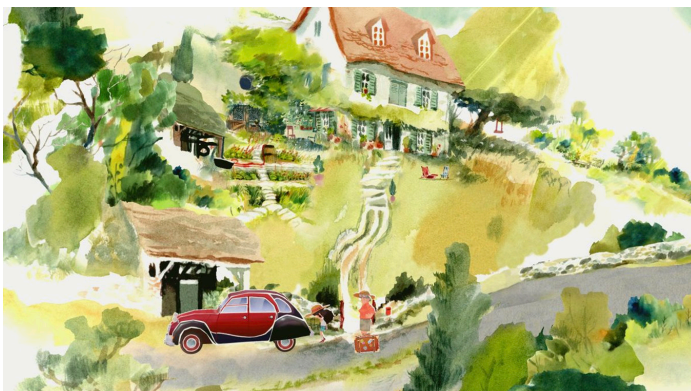
Text

SN: A visual style where the game is primarily conveyed through text.



Watercolor

SN: A visual style where characters and environments are presented as though they are painted in water color.



Other: style

SN: When the visual style cannot be described by any of terms in the style facet, please record "other."

2. Color

Achromatic

SN: A style that mainly portrays characters or environments in shades of black and white.



Colorful

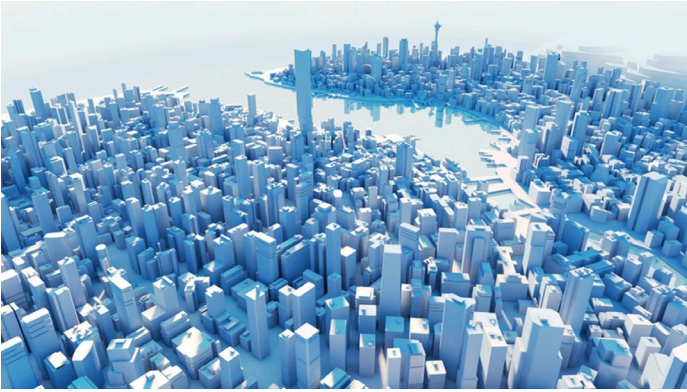
SN: A visual style using many and varied colors.



3. Light

Bright

SN: A visual style characterized by highly saturated colors.



Dark

SN: A visual style characterized by having highly desaturated colors.

